

LOCAL SPORTS

Midview breaks through for first victory

Scott Petrak
Chronicle-Telegram

COLUMBIA STATION — Coaches love to talk about defense winning championships. Well, Midview isn't likely to win a championship this year, but good defense did lead the Middies to their first boys basketball win of the season.

Midview downed Columbia 63-49 Wednesday night.

After losing their first six games of the season, the Middies scored a season-high 63 points, committed a season-low 11 turnovers and used a tough match-up

zone in winning the non-conference game.

"We played excellent defense," Midview coach Ray Verba said. "We forced them to take some shots that weren't easy. (The win) was a long time coming, but a good one."

Midview's match-up zone forced the Raider guards out beyond the three-point arc and made the entry passes to the post difficult.

"Their matchup zone bothered us," Columbia coach Mike Verdi said. "They're really the only team that plays it, so we only see it once a year. I just thought we

were flat for whatever reason."

Columbia (3-4) led 12-9 after one quarter, despite committing six of its 23 turnovers. Mark Skor led the Raiders with seven of his team-high 13 points.

Midview took the lead for good at 17-14 on a three-point play by junior Gabe Turner with less than four minutes remaining in the first half. The Middies held Columbia to seven points in the second quarter to lead 23-19 at the break.

The Middies continued to increase their advantage with two 20-point quarters in the second half.

"Finally our shot selection was pretty good," Verba said. "We also converted a lot of free throws. When we shoot a lot of foul shots and we make them, it puts a lot of points on the board."

Midview went to the foul line 31 times, making 23, while Columbia was 4 of 9 from the line.

Senior Kevin Klein led the Middies with a game-high 18 points, 14 in the second half. Senior guard Kris Crawford added 17, many coming on drives after he had gotten past the defender at the top of the key.

"Kris Crawford did a great job

running that offense where he got a chance to drive a little bit," Verba said.

Columbia made a run in the fourth quarter. With 3:56 left, senior Barry Morton scored the last of his 12 points on a jumper to pull the Raiders within 50-46.

But Midview's defense tightened and Columbia continued to turn the ball over. The Middies outscored Columbia 13-0 until a last-second three by Columbia accounted for the final margin.

"Our offense struggled big time," Verdi said. "This is like an annual affair for us. We always struggle over the holidays. I'm very disappointed."

"Twenty-three turnovers playing against a zone, without any press is ridiculous."

Midview hosts Admiral King tomorrow night and the Raiders are off until Jan. 5 when they travel to Lutheran West.

Midview	G	F	T	Columbia	G	F	T
Ky Crawford	0	2	2	Skor	6	0	13
Delaney	0	2	2	Kelly	2	3	7
Klein	6	7	18	Putzer	4	2	8
Ky Crawford	0	2	2	Barger	4	1	8
Price	2	1	5	Morton	6	0	12
Dennis	3	5	11	Wolf	1	0	3
Turner	3	2	8	May	0	0	0
Shultzberg	0	0	0	Samson	0	0	0
				Ewell	0	0	0
				Szszak	0	0	0
Totals	15	23	43	Totals	27	4	46

Midview	G	F	T	Columbia	G	F	T
Midview	12	7	15	23	4	2	8
Three-point goals	Midview	3	Klein, Crawford	0	0	0	0
Columbia	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
JV: Midview, 50-39.							

Roth's 22 lead Amherst to win

Bob West
The Chronicle-Telegram

VERMILION — Amherst's 84-54 rout of Vermilion Wednesday night was another Christmas present for Comet coach Dave Zvara.

"The kids are playing with a lot of confidence right now," Zvara said of one of his early season concerns with his team. "And that confidence has come a lot more quickly than I thought it would. Merry Christmas!"

Unfortunately for Vermilion coach Bob Walsh, it appeared as though the Grinch handled the shopping for him and his team.

"We rely on our defense to win games and we didn't play any tonight," Walsh said. "And we fouled too much when we did play any defense."

Amherst (5-1) was the beneficiary of those Sailor fouls, hitting twice as many free throws as Vermilion (4-3) attempted. The Comets were 27-for-38 from the charity stripe on the night, while Vermilion was 10-of-13 from the line.

The free throws were the difference in the game during the second quarter when Amherst hit 15-of-18 free throws to build a 43-23 intermission lead which Vermilion never challenged.

A 120 Comet burst in the quarter included eight free throws as Amherst regularly pounded the ball inside to 6-foot-7 center Scott Roth. "Kris (White) and Scott (Roth) had a nice little combination going there for a while," Zvara said. The pair totaled 10 points in the quarter, and Roth led all scorers

for the game with 22.

After a first quarter in which the teams shot a combined 63 percent from the field, the game took on a much more physical note in the second quarter and both teams struggled from the field.

Vermilion hit just 2-of-11 field goals in the quarter while scoring only nine points against an aggressive Comet zone.

"We didn't shoot the ball as well as we have the past few games. If you do that and you don't play good defense, you're not going to win," Walsh said. "When we let teams get into the 60s and 70s against us, we're in trouble. We don't have that type of offense."

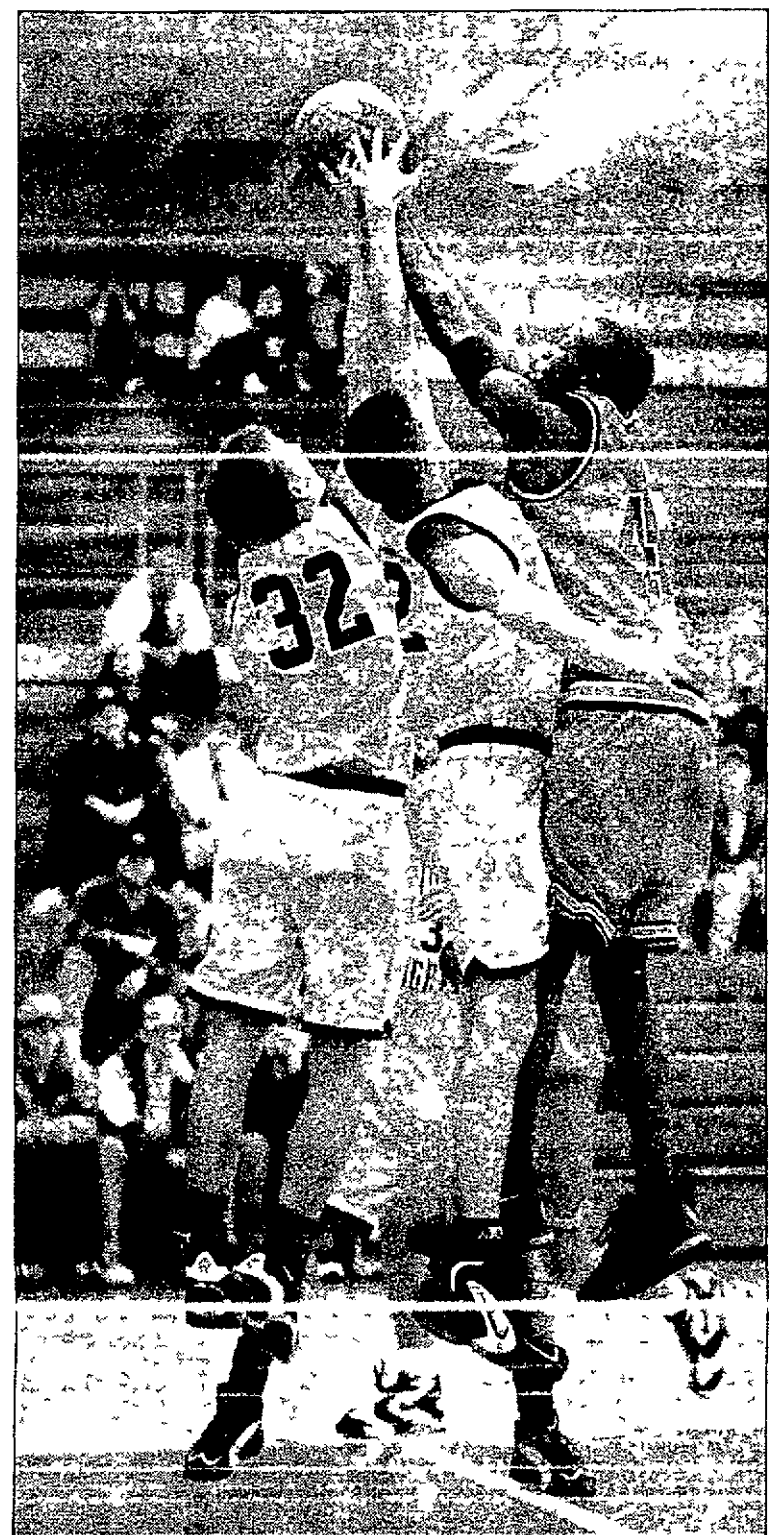
Walsh pointed out that the Sailors have now lost each game in which their opponents have scored at least 60 points.

Ed Cyrek led the Sailors with 17 points, supported by Chris Parmenter's 12 and Hubie Bartlett's 11. White and Todd Damsiewicz each netted 17 for the Comets.

Amherst hosts Rocky River in Southwestern Conference action Friday and Vermilion visits Huron on Saturday.

Amherst	G	F	T	Vermilion	G	F	T
White	4	6	17	Sheets	0	2	2
Pena	1	0	3	Adams	1	0	0
Deitz	0	4	4	Cox	2	2	6
Dusho	0	2	6	ECyrk	6	6	17
Parmenter	0	1	17	Bartlett	5	1	11
Azok	0	2	2	Bartlett	5	1	11
Roth	0	2	22	Burnett	1	0	2
Lewis	0	1	1	ECyrk	1	0	2
Lugar	0	1	5				
Burke	3	0	7				
Totals	25	27	84	Totals	22	10	54

Three-point goals: Amherst: White 3, Pena, Burke, Jayvee Amherst 43-29



CHUCK HUMEL / CHRONICLE

HIGH RISERS: Elyria West's Nate Crutcher, right, battles North Ridgeville's Jason Daniels (32) and David Baker for a rebound in Wednesday's game at North Ridgeville.

WEST

From C1

ines were 15 of 27. They out-rebounded the Rangers, 34-25, but committed 18 turnovers. North Ridgeville had 21.

West (3-4) won its second junior varsity game in a row, 52-43. Jermele Nolen scored 15 for coach Ron Bier's squad while Robby Elkins had 14 for North Ridgeville.

Both teams return to action Friday. West is at Keystone in Lorain County Conference action while the Rangers host Southview in Erie Shore play.

Ten Wolverines scored to help compensate for the absence of top substitute Jakanda Dickerson, who may miss a week's worth of action because of a twisted ankle suffered in Tuesday's practice.

For North Ridgeville, Kevin Jackson scored eight points in the final period to finish with a team-high 14. Ryan Sgro added 10 but the Rangers never were in the game once West scored 10 unanswered points in the first period to break a 2-2 tie. The widest gap was 34 points, 55-21, two minutes into the final period.

West shot well enough, hitting 24 of 52 (46 percent), especially considering the 4-of-13 fourth period.

From the foul line, the Wolver-

ines were 15 of 27. They out-rebounded the Rangers, 34-25, but committed 18 turnovers. North Ridgeville had 21.

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Players	BA	G	F	A	T	P
Nate Crutcher	15	10	5	3	2	24
Damon Malone	5	3	2	1	2	9
Brad Schell	5	3	2	1	2	9
Rob West	3	2	2	1	2	9
Marlon Wade	3	2	2	1	2	9
Marcus Trice	2	1	1	0	1	4
Brad Jenkins	2	1	1	0	1	4
Rock Kiser	2	1	1	0	1	4
Archie Taylor	1	1	1	0	1	4
Jermele Nolen	1	1	1	0	1	4
Totals	52	24	27	15	23	67

Players	BA	G	F	A	T	P
Kevin Jackson	13	5	4	7	2	3
Ryan Sgro	4	3	4	2	2	10
Todd Weber	4	1	7	2	2	5
Neil Cheon	3	2	2	1	1	5
Pete VanHiel	2	2	2	1	1	4
Jason Daniels	2	2	2	1	1	4
Dan McKenna	2	2	2	1	1	4
Scott Lane	2	2	2	1	1	4
Dan McCoslin	2	2	2	1	1	4
David Baker	2	2	2	1	1	4
Totals	43	14	25	10	21	40

Three-point field goals: Elyria West, Damon Malone (2), Nate Crutcher, Brad Schell, North Ridgeville, Kevin Jackson (2)

SCORE BY QUARTERS

Elyria West 1 2 3 4 T

North Ridge 14 13 20 20 — 67

Junior Varsity: Elyria West, 52-43

Fairview.....31

Midpark.....40

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N. Olmsted defense puts clamp on Elyria

ELYRIA — North Olmsted held Elyria to 14 baskets from the floor in racking up a 47-37 girls non-conference basketball victory Wednesday.

After pulling even at 26-26 in the third quarter, the Pioneers (4-3, 1-1 Erie Shore Conference) failed to take advantage of a number of scoring opportunities as the Eagles (5-4) eventually scored the next six points of the game.

The Eagles were aided by strong foul shooting throughout the game, while the Pioneers mustered just two fourth quarter baskets.

Kim Abbott and Kendall Albert scored 12 points each to lead North Olmsted, while Tysheka Madison also totaled 12 points to lead the Pioneers.

North Olmsted led 12-11 after the first quarter, 23-15 at the half, 37-15 at the three-quarter mark and 47-14 at the end of the game.

The win raised the Meteors to 6-2 on the season. Midpark visits Strongsville next Wednesday.

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